CTL DECISION SHEET (DSH)

Standard(s) (incl. year)	Subclause(s)	Tracking No.	Year
IEC 60601-1:2005 + Am1	11.7 Biocompatibility of ME Equipment and ME Systems	2022	2015
Category			
MED			
Subject	**Keywords**	**Developed by**	**Approved at**
Need to assess biocompatibility of operator contact parts	Biocompatibility ISO 10993 series	ETF-3	2016 CTL Plenary Meeting

Question

It is often interpreted that only those parts that come into contact with the patient need to be assessed for biocompatibility. However, there can be parts of equipment, such as handles, that may be in contact with the operator for a long time.
Is the possibility of the operator to wear protective gear (e.g. gloves) sufficient to obviate this part of assessment?

Decision

ISO 10993 series only apply to materials and devices in direct or indirect contact with the patient's body. However, the risk management process should also address any operator safety issues such as Biocompatibility.

Explanatory notes

Intention of the safety standard is to protect both the patient and the operator. Unless there is a requirement in the User's Instructions to wear protective gear (gloves etc) while using the equipment, the parts that come into contact with the operator will need to be assessed for biocompatibility.